FIGHTERBASE

Primal

Food list

Every allowed and avoided food, by type. Like paleo, with some dairy.



Prepared 11 October 2026 for FighterBase members. Eating styles library, one of a set.

> DRAFT: not yet reviewed by a registered dietitian. General information only, not medical advice. Check with your doctor or a registered dietitian before changing how you eat, especially if you have a medical condition, are pregnant, or are under 18.

USING FIGHTERBASE

How to use this food list

This food list is part of your eating styles library in the FighterBase app. The pages that follow are built to be skimmed. You do not need to read it all at once.

1. **Open Nutrition**
   In the app, open the **Nutrition** tab and tap **Eating styles**.

2. **Tap Primal**
   Read the short summary, what to eat, what to go easy on, and what to watch.

3. **Follow it**
   Tap **Follow this style**. Recipes and the Foods list then filter to match, so you only see what fits. You can follow more than one style.

4. **Download the PDFs**
   Use **Full food list** and **Diet guide** to save these to your phone. Handy for the shop or a restaurant.

5. **Log it and train**
   Meals you log count towards your day. Spend your energy on training, not on reading labels.

The colour key

Green	Amber	Red	Blue
Allowed. Fits this style.	In moderation, small amounts or some versions.	Avoid. The reason is shown.	Check the label or how it is made.
289 allowed	**24** in moderation	**192** avoid	**0** check label

Brand products vary. This list is built from the FighterBase food catalogue of 505 common foods. If a food is not here, ask which group it belongs to and check the label.

AT A GLANCE

Primal on one page

A close cousin of paleo that allows full-fat dairy and is a bit more relaxed about some foods.

Mostly yes

- Beef steak (sirloin, rump, ribeye, fillet)
- Beef mince (5% to 20% fat)
- Salmon (fresh, farmed or wild)
- Trout
- Hen eggs (whole)
- Egg whites (carton)
- Spinach
- Kale
- Carrots
- Beetroot
- Strawberries
- Blueberries
- Almonds
- Walnuts
- Extra virgin olive oil
- Olive oil (light)

Mostly no

- White bread
- Wholemeal and granary bread
- Wheat pasta (white or wholewheat)
- Egg pasta and fresh pasta
- Processed cheese slices and spreads
- Whey protein
- Red lentils
- Green and brown lentils
- White and brown sugar
- Agave syrup
- Tofu (firm, silken, smoked)
- Tempeh
- Hot chocolate
- Squash and cordial

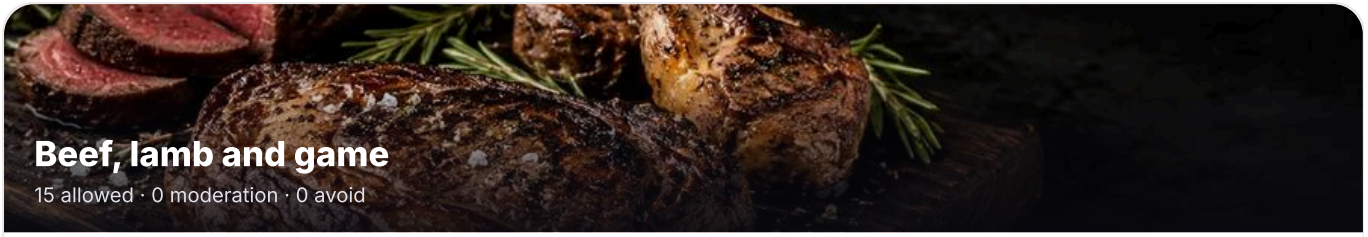
The big ideas

1. Eat meat, fish, eggs, vegetables, fruit, nuts and seeds.
2. Quality dairy (full-fat, grass-fed, fermented) is allowed if it suits you.
3. Avoid grains, sugar, processed food, seed oils and most legumes.
4. Dark chocolate and a little red wine are fine in moderation (the '80/20' idea).
5. Lifestyle counts too: sleep, walking, play and sun.

> **Talk to a professional first if:** You have a medical condition, allergy or intolerance; You are pregnant, breastfeeding or under 18; You have ever had an eating disorder; You are cutting weight for a fight.

THE FULL LIST

Every food, by type



Beef, lamb and game

15 allowed · 0 moderation · 0 avoid

ALLOWED 15

Beef steak (sirloin, rump, ribeye, fillet) · Beef mince (5% to 20% fat) · Beef joint (topside, brisket, silverside) · Beef short ribs and oxtail · Beef burgers (home-made, 100% beef) · Lamb chops, leg and shoulder · Lamb mince · Mutton · Goat · Venison · Rabbit · Wild boar · Bison and buffalo · Pheasant, partridge and grouse · Veal



Pork and cured meats

5 allowed · 0 moderation · 9 avoid

ALLOWED 5

Pork loin, chops and tenderloin · Pork belly and pork shoulder · Pork mince · Gammon and ham joint · Lard

AVOID 9

Bacon (back and streaky) · processed · Sausages (pork) · processed · Sausages (beef or chicken, check the label) · processed · Ham slices (deli) · processed · Salami, chorizo and pepperoni · processed · Pork pies and scotch eggs · processed · Pate and liver sausage · processed · Black pudding · processed · Pulled pork (ready-made, sweetened sauce) · processed



Poultry

8 allowed · 0 moderation · 3 avoid

ALLOWED 8

Chicken breast · Chicken thighs and drumsticks (skin on or off) · Whole roast chicken · Chicken wings · Chicken mince · Turkey breast and turkey mince · Duck breast and duck leg · Goose

AVOID 3

Chicken nuggets and breaded chicken · processed · Chicken sausages and deli chicken slices · processed · Rotisserie chicken (shop-bought, check seasoning) · processed



Offal and bones

10 allowed · 0 moderation · 0 avoid

ALLOWED 10

Liver (beef, lamb, chicken) · Kidney · Heart · Tongue · Tripe · Bone marrow · Bone broth (home-made) · Beef dripping and tallow · Duck fat and goose fat · Gelatine and collagen powder



Fish

26 allowed · 0 moderation · 5 avoid

ALLOWED 26

Salmon (fresh, farmed or wild) · Trout · Mackerel · Sardines (fresh or tinned in oil or water) · Herring and kippers · Anchovies · Pilchards · Tuna (fresh steak) · Tuna (tinned) · Cod · Haddock · Pollock and coley · Plaice and sole · Sea bass and sea bream · Halibut and turbot · Hake · Whitebait · Skate · Monkfish · Swordfish · Catfish · Eel · Shark · Sturgeon and caviar · Fish roe (cod roe, salmon roe) · Cod liver oil

AVOID 5

Smoked salmon · processed · Fish fingers and breaded fish · processed · Fish cakes · processed · Fish paste and pate · processed · Surimi and crab sticks · processed



Shellfish and seafood

13 allowed · 0 moderation · 0 avoid

ALLOWED 13

Prawns and shrimp · King prawns and tiger prawns · Crab · Lobster · Langoustine and crayfish · Mussels · Oysters · Scallops · Clams and cockles · Whelks and winkles · Squid and calamari · Octopus · Cuttlefish



Eggs

5 allowed · 0 moderation · 3 avoid

ALLOWED 5

Hen eggs (whole) · Egg whites (carton) · Duck eggs · Quail eggs · Omelette and scrambled egg

AVOID 3

Mayonnaise · industrial seed oil | Egg noodles · grain | Meringue · added sugar



Milk and cream

6 allowed · 5 moderation · 0 avoid

ALLOWED 6

Goat's milk and sheep's milk | Soured cream and creme fraiche | Milk powder | Butter | Ghee (clarified butter) | Buttermilk

MODERATION 5

Whole milk · best full-fat, small amounts | Semi-skimmed and skimmed milk · best full-fat, small amounts | Lactose-free milk · best full-fat, small amounts | Single, double and whipping cream · full-fat, small amounts | Condensed and evaporated milk · sugar, occasional



Yoghurt, kefir and soft cheeses

11 allowed · 0 moderation · 1 avoid

ALLOWED 11

Plain natural yoghurt | Greek yoghurt | Skyr | Kefir | Cottage cheese | Quark | Cream cheese | Ricotta | Mascarpone | Mozzarella | Paneer

AVOID 1

Flavoured and fruit yoghurt · added sugar



Hard and mature cheeses

9 allowed · 1 moderation · 5 avoid

ALLOWED 9

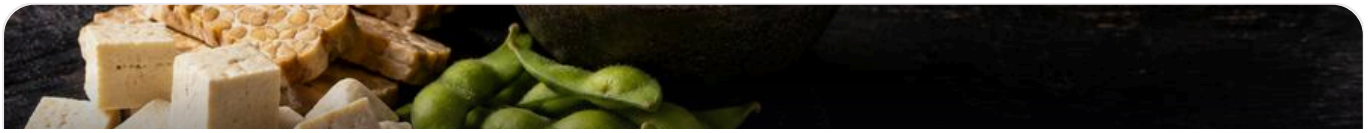
Cheddar | Parmesan and grana padano (animal rennet) | Edam and gouda | Emmental and gruyere | Brie and camembert | Blue cheese (stilton, gorgonzola) | Feta | Halloumi | Goat's cheese

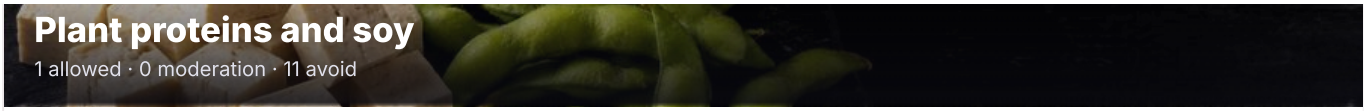
MODERATION 1

Ice cream · sugar, occasional

AVOID 5

Processed cheese slices and spreads · processed | Whey protein · processed | Casein protein · processed | Custard and milk puddings · added sugar | Milkshakes · added sugar





Plant proteins and soy

1 allowed · 0 moderation · 11 avoid

ALLOWED 1

Nutritional yeast

AVOID 11

Tofu (firm, silken, smoked) · soy
Tempeh · soy
Edamame · soy
Soya mince and soya chunks · soy
Soya milk and soya yoghurt · soy
Seitan (wheat protein) · contains gluten
Quorn and mycoprotein (many contain egg white) · processed
Plant-based burgers and sausages · processed
Pea protein and rice protein powder · legume
Miso · soy
Natto · soy



Beans, lentils and pulses

3 allowed · 0 moderation · 21 avoid

ALLOWED 3

Green beans and runner beans
Garden peas and petits pois
Mangetout and sugar snap peas

AVOID 21

Red lentils · legume
Green and brown lentils · legume
Puy lentils · legume
Chickpeas · legume
Black beans · legume
Kidney beans · legume
Cannellini and haricot beans · legume
Butter beans · legume
Pinto beans · legume
Borlotti beans · legume
Broad beans · legume
Black-eyed peas · legume
Split peas · legume
Lupin beans · legume
Hummus · legume
Falafel · legume
Baked beans in tomato sauce · legume
Refried beans · legume
Peanuts · legume
Peanut butter · legume
Bean and lentil pasta · legume



Bread and bakery

3 allowed · 0 moderation · 23 avoid

ALLOWED 3

Almond-flour bread and wraps
Coconut-flour wraps
Cloud bread

AVOID 23

White bread · grain
Wholemeal and granary bread · grain
Sourdough bread · grain
Rye bread · grain
Seeded bread · grain
Gluten-free bread · processed
Pitta and flatbreads · grain
Wraps and tortillas (wheat) · grain
Corn tortillas · grain
Naan and chapati · grain
Bagels · grain
Crumpets and muffins · grain
Croissants and pastries · grain
Pizza base · grain
Crackers and crispbreads · grain
Oatcakes · grain
Rice cakes · grain
Cakes and sponge · grain
Biscuits and cookies · grain
Doughnuts · grain
Pies and pasties · grain
Cereal bars and flapjacks · grain
Protein bars · added sugar



Pasta, rice and grains

8 allowed · 1 moderation · 32 avoid

ALLOWED 8

Glass noodles · Chia pudding · Cauliflower rice · Courgette noodles (courgetti) · Konjac (shirataki) noodles · Flours: almond · Flours: coconut · Flours: tapioca and arrowroot

MODERATION 1

White rice (basmati, jasmine, long-grain) · occasional, around training

AVOID 32

Wheat pasta (white or wholewheat) · grain · Egg pasta and fresh pasta · grain · Gluten-free pasta (corn or rice) · grain · Noodles (wheat) and ramen · grain · Rice noodles · grain · Couscous · grain · Bulgur wheat · grain · Semolina · grain · Freekeh, spelt, farro and kamut · grain · Barley and pearl barley · grain · Brown rice · grain · Wild rice · grain · Risotto rice · grain · Sushi rice · grain · Oats (rolled and porridge) · grain · Oat bran · grain · Muesli and granola · grain · Breakfast cereals (cornflakes, bran flakes) · grain · Shredded wheat and wheat biscuits · grain · Quinoa · pseudo-grain · Buckwheat · pseudo-grain · Amaranth · pseudo-grain · Millet · grain · Sorghum · grain · Teff · grain · Polenta and cornmeal · grain · Sweetcorn and corn on the cob · grain · Popcorn · grain · Tortilla chips · grain · Flours: wheat and plain · grain · Flours: rice, cornflour and maize · grain · Flours: chickpea (gram) · legume



Leafy and salad vegetables

12 allowed · 0 moderation · 0 avoid

ALLOWED 12

Spinach · Kale · Cabbage (green, red, savoy) · Spring greens and collards · Lettuce and salad leaves · Rocket and watercress · Chard · Pak choi and bok choy · Cucumber · Celery · Radishes · Bean sprouts



Cruciferous and stalk vegetables

10 allowed · 0 moderation · 0 avoid

ALLOWED 10

Broccoli · Cauliflower · Brussels sprouts · Asparagus · Fennel · Artichoke · Kohlrabi · Leeks · Courgette and marrow · Aubergine





Onions, peppers and tomatoes

10 allowed · 0 moderation · 0 avoid

ALLOWED 10

Onions and shallots · Garlic · Spring onions and chives · Peppers (red, green, yellow) · Chillies · Tomatoes (fresh, tinned, passata) · Tomato puree · Mushrooms (all types) · Olives · Avocado



Roots, squash and starchy vegetables

20 allowed · 2 moderation · 2 avoid

ALLOWED 20

Carrots · Beetroot · Parsnips · Swede and turnip · Celeriac · Butternut squash and pumpkin · Sweet potato · Chips (home-made, oven) · Yam · Cassava (yuca) and tapioca · Plantain · Taro · Jerusalem artichoke · Seaweed and nori · Sauerkraut · Kimchi · Pickles and gherkins · Frozen vegetables (plain) · Tinned vegetables (no added sugar) · Vegetable juice

MODERATION 2

White potatoes (boiled, baked, mashed) · debated, small amounts or around training

Roast potatoes · debated, small amounts or around training

AVOID 2

Chips and fries (takeaway or frozen) · processed

Parsnip and potato crisps (vegetable crisps) · processed



Fruit

28 allowed · 6 moderation · 2 avoid

ALLOWED 28

Strawberries · Blueberries · Raspberries · Blackberries · Cranberries and redcurrants · Lemons and limes · Apples · Pears · Oranges and satsumas · Grapefruit · Peaches and nectarines · Plums · Apricots · Cherries · Kiwi · Melon (cantaloupe, honeydew) · Watermelon · Pineapple · Mango · Papaya · Grapes · Bananas · Figs (fresh) · Pomegranate · Passion fruit · Coconut (fresh flesh) · Smoothies (home-made, whole fruit) · Coconut water

MODERATION 6

Dates · dried fruit sugars add up, small amounts

Raisins, sultanas and currants · dried fruit sugars add up, small amounts

Dried apricots, figs and prunes · dried fruit sugars add up, small amounts

Other dried fruit and fruit leather · dried fruit sugars add up, small amounts

Fruit juice · liquid sugar, small amounts · Smoothies (shop-bought) · liquid sugar, small amounts

AVOID 2

Tinned fruit in juice · added sugar · Tinned fruit in syrup · added sugar



Nuts and seeds

21 allowed · 0 moderation · 3 avoid

ALLOWED 21

Almonds · Walnuts · Cashews · Pecans · Hazelnuts · Brazil nuts · Macadamias · Pistachios · Pine nuts · Chestnuts · Mixed nuts (plain) · Chia seeds · Flaxseed (linseed) · Hemp seeds · Pumpkin seeds · Sunflower seeds · Sesame seeds and tahini · Poppy seeds · Almond butter · Cashew butter · Coconut flakes and desiccated coconut

AVOID 3

Salted and flavoured nuts · processed · Trail mix (with dried fruit and chocolate) · added sugar · Hazelnut chocolate spread · added sugar

Oils, fats and spreads

9 allowed · 0 moderation · 8 avoid

ALLOWED 9

Extra virgin olive oil · Olive oil (light) · Avocado oil · Coconut oil · MCT oil · Flaxseed oil · Walnut oil · Sesame oil · Palm oil

AVOID 8

Rapeseed (canola) oil · industrial seed oil · Sunflower oil · industrial seed oil · Vegetable oil and corn oil · industrial seed oil · Soybean oil · industrial seed oil · Margarine and baking spreads · industrial seed oil · Dairy-free spreads · industrial seed oil · Cooking spray · industrial seed oil · Salad dressings (bottled) · industrial seed oil

Sugars, sweeteners and sweet foods

4 allowed · 5 moderation · 16 avoid

ALLOWED 4

Stevia · Monk fruit · Erythritol and xylitol · Cocoa powder (unsweetened)

MODERATION 5

Honey · natural sweetener, small amounts · Maple syrup · natural sweetener, small amounts · Date syrup and date paste · natural sweetener, small amounts · Dark chocolate 70% or higher · 85% cocoa or higher, a small square · Dark chocolate 85% or higher · 85% cocoa or higher, a small square

AVOID 16

White and brown sugar · added sugar | Agave syrup · added sugar | Golden syrup, treacle and molasses · added sugar | Coconut sugar · added sugar | Aspartame, sucralose and saccharin · artificial sweetener | Jam, marmalade and fruit spreads · added sugar | Milk chocolate · added sugar | White chocolate · added sugar | Sweets, gummies and jelly · added sugar | Marshmallows · added sugar | Fizzy and boiled sweets · added sugar | Energy gels and chews · added sugar | Sherbet and candyfloss · added sugar | Fruit pastilles and wine gums · added sugar | Protein ice cream and low-sugar desserts · artificial sweetener | Vegan chocolate · added sugar



Herbs, spices and flavourings

16 allowed · 1 moderation · 2 avoid

ALLOWED 16

Salt (sea, table, rock) | Black pepper | Basil, oregano, thyme and rosemary | Parsley, coriander, mint and dill | Sage, bay and tarragon | Cumin, coriander seed and fennel seed | Turmeric | Paprika and smoked paprika | Chilli flakes and cayenne | Cinnamon, nutmeg and cloves | Ginger (fresh and ground) | Garlic powder and onion powder | Mustard seeds | Vanilla (pods) | Curry powder and garam masala (check blends) | Mixed herbs and Italian seasoning

MODERATION 1

Vanilla extract (alcohol-based) · alcohol

AVOID 2

Seasoning mixes and rubs (check label) · processed | Stock cubes and gravy granules · processed



Sauces and condiments

11 allowed · 0 moderation · 17 avoid

ALLOWED 11

Mustard (English, Dijon, wholegrain) | Coconut aminos | Fish sauce | Hot sauce (chilli) | Apple cider vinegar | White wine, red wine and rice vinegar | Pesto (basil and pine nut) | Dairy-free pesto | Salsa | Guacamole | Gravy (home-made, no flour)

AVOID 17

Tomato ketchup · added sugar | Brown sauce · added sugar | BBQ sauce · added sugar | Mayonnaise (light) · industrial seed oil | Soy sauce · soy | Tamari (wheat-free soy sauce) · soy | Oyster sauce · added sugar | Worcestershire sauce · contains gluten | Sriracha · added sugar | Balsamic vinegar · added sugar | Malt vinegar · contains gluten | Curry sauce (jar) · added sugar | Pasta sauce (jar) · added sugar | Sweet chilli sauce · added sugar | Teriyaki sauce · soy | Hoisin sauce · soy | Coleslaw (shop-bought) · industrial seed oil

Drinks

11 allowed · 3 moderation · 13 avoid

ALLOWED 11

Water (still and sparkling) · Tea (black, green, white) · Herbal and fruit teas · Coffee (black) · Coffee with milk or cream · Decaffeinated coffee and tea · Electrolyte tablets and powders (sugar-free) · Almond, cashew and hazelnut milk · Coconut milk drink · Alcohol-free beer · Bone broth drink

MODERATION 3

Wine (red, white, rose) · alcohol · Spirits (whisky, gin, vodka, rum) · alcohol · Gluten-free beer · alcohol

AVOID 13

Hot chocolate · added sugar · Squash and cordial · added sugar · Fizzy drinks (cola, lemonade) · added sugar · Diet and zero-sugar fizzy drinks · artificial sweetener · Energy drinks · added sugar · Sports drinks · added sugar · Oat milk · oats · Rice milk · grain · Pea milk · legume · Kombucha · added sugar · Beer and lager · contains gluten · Cider · added sugar · Liqueurs and alcopops · added sugar

Ready meals and takeaway

4 allowed · 0 moderation · 14 avoid

ALLOWED 4

Home-made vegetable soup · Jacket potato with filling · Salad with grilled chicken · Stir-fry (home-made)

AVOID 14

Pizza · grain · Burgers in buns · grain · Kebabs · grain · Fish and chips · grain · Takeaway curry with rice · grain · Chinese takeaway · grain · Sushi · grain · Sandwiches and subs · grain · Crisps · processed · Pot noodles and instant noodles · grain · Ready meals · processed · Tinned soup (check label) · processed · Sausage rolls · grain · Burrito and fajitas · grain

Supplements

10 allowed · 0 moderation · 2 avoid

ALLOWED 10

Creatine monohydrate · Fish oil (omega-3) · Algae omega-3 · Vitamin D3 (from lanolin) · Vitamin D (from lichen) · Multivitamin and mineral tablet · Magnesium · Caffeine tablets · BCAAs and EAAs · Collagen peptides

AVOID 2

Pea or rice protein · legume · Soy protein · soy

READ THE LABEL

Hidden ingredients

Ingredients can hide in the small print. Look for these on packaging, menus and supplements.

- Sugar and starch hide as: maltodextrin, glucose syrup, wheat starch, dextrose
- Seed oils: sunflower, rapeseed (canola), soybean, corn oil
- Check flavoured yoghurts and sauces for added sugar

For fighters and combat athletes

- **No eating style makes a rapid weight cut safe.** Sweating, fluid restriction and crash diets hurt performance and can be dangerous. Plan any weight cut with a registered sports dietitian and your coach, well before the weigh-in.
- **Fuel the training first.** Hard sparring and conditioning need carbohydrate and enough total food. If a style cuts a food group, have a plan to replace what is lost.
- **Protein across the day.** A common general range for people training hard is about 1.4 to 2.0 g per kg of body weight a day (draft range, to be confirmed by a dietitian).
- **Try changes in training, never in fight week.** Test new foods, supplements and timing well before competition.
- **Under 18, pregnant, or with a medical condition:** get advice from a doctor or dietitian before changing your diet.

FIGHTERBASE

Train. Eat. Recover. Repeat.

Your eating styles library lives in the Nutrition tab. Pick a style, follow it, and get back to training.

DRAFT: not yet reviewed by a registered dietitian. General information only, not medical advice. Check with your doctor or a registered dietitian before changing how you eat, especially if you have a medical condition, are pregnant, or are under 18.